

REGISTER

The register is defined as the way a speaker uses language differently in different circumstances. Think about the words you choose, your tone of voice, even your body language. ...Registers are used in all forms of **communication**, including written, spoken, and signed.

One means of communication that is common to human being is language. There are many other means such as gesture with hand, facial expression, winks, ringing of bells etc. all these communicate and convey one meaning or the other.

Quirk and Greenbaum (1977) sees registers as the varieties of English according to the subject matter involved in a discourse.

Little (1980) defines register as the total characteristics of any sample of language in relation to the particular purpose for which it is intended.

Nnamani (2010) views register as the language peculiar to various professions.

Register therefore shows that a language has many varieties which human beings use to communicate in relation to the situation or occasion in which he/she finds himself/herself. Thus register is said to be language in situation.

Looking at Nnamani definition of register which educate us that knowledge of various registers helps us tailor our speech to suit our audience. It helps us select a level of language that is appropriate to every situation.

The importance of register on an audience is revealed in the following illustrations example the language suitable among students may not be appropriate between a student and a lecturer as the following conversation reveals,

A. Lecturer: Did you understand what I just explain?

Student: yea, ride on Or No, rewind

B. Lecturer: Did you understand what I just explain?

Student: yes, I did. Please go ahead. Or No, I didn't. Please could you say that again?

In the above conversation, the student response in "B" is standard while the student response in 'A' uses slang words the student who respond to his teacher in that way is regarded as rude.

Let us consider another scenario. You are a professional accountant addressing the professional shareholder of the company you manage, because your audience is mixed multitude, (i.e. layman and professionals) you will be considered arrogant if your paper is full of accounting jargons. Ideally, you should use a general register: word phrases and sentences which can be understood by all people.

But if the same accountant were presenting a paper at a conference organized by professional accountants he will use terminologies readily understood by his colleague to a large extent, therefore, your audience determines your register.

Factors affecting or sharpen register

i. **Field of discourse:** a speaker or a writer uses language register in a particular situation or context. This situation or context is generally referred to as subject matter. More technically, it is called the field of discourse.

ii. **Mode of discourse:** this refers to the medium either spoken or written that is used in a letter in the spoken medium; In analyzing the mode of a discourse therefore, we pay attention to the tone of the speaker which suggests anger, dislike, friendliness etc. (sound pattern); lexical items which reveal the subject matter (vocabulary pattern) and the sentence constructions, spelling, punctuation, etc. example, looking at the American and British spelling, pronunciation etc.

Spelling		Pronunciation	
American	British	American	British
Meter	Metre	tomato	Tomato
Center	Centre	Banana	Banana
Hono	Honour	GO	Go
Color	Colour		
Dialog	Dialogue		
Lexical Item		Punctuation	
American	British	American	British
Railroad	Railway	Mr.	Mr
Lift	Elevator	Dr.	Dr
Boot	Trunk	Rd.	Rd
Ave.	Ave		

- i. **Style of discourse:** this has to be with degree of formality of language used in a text whether formal, informal, casual, etc. is called the style of discourse. In other words, style is the kind of language use, which is the result of the combination of subject matter, mode and tenor.

Note: the used of grammar between American and British English.

In American English the simple past can be used with already, just and yet. While British English the present is used. Example

- Have you heard the news yet? (British)
- Did you hear the news yet? (American)
- When the past participate is used as adjective, British English prefers the 't' form, where as in American English the 'ed' form is preferred examples.
 - A spoilt child (British)
 - A spoiled (American)
- On the telephone for instance, the style of discourse between British and American English as;
 - Hello is that David? (British)
 - Hello is this David? (American)

PRINCIPLES OF CORRESPONDENCE

Business correspondence and official letters are written in various circumstances. They include application letters, letters of appointment, appreciation letters, query, complaints, congratulatory letters, inquiry, order, condolence, invitation etc.

- i. **Condolence letters** are written messages to someone who is experiencing the loss of a loved one
- ii. **Invitation Letter** is a document that presents a **formal** request for the presence of an individual, a group of people or an organization at an event. An **invitation letter** may be **formal** or informal. It could be printed on paper or sent via email.
- iii. **Complaint Letter** is a type of **letter** written to address any type wrong doing, offence, **grievance**, resentment arising out of a product, service etc
- iv. **Query letter** is a **formal letter** sent to magazine editors, literary agents and sometimes publishing houses or companies. Writers write **query letters** to propose

COMPONENTS OF A BUSINESS LETTER

1. **Writers address:** This is usually written in the top right hand corner of the page. It may be written in block form or indented form. It may also have open or closed punctuation depending on preference. An address has open punctuation when there are no punctuation marks at the end of each line of the address e.g.

(a) Block form

i. Open punctuation

Yukur Ventures Plc
P.M.B 1045
Makurdi
Benue State

ii. Closed punctuation

Yukur Ventures Plc,
P.M.B 1045,
Makurdi,
Benue state.

(b) Indented form

i. Open punctuation

Yukur Ventures plc
P.M.B. 1045
Makurdi
Benue State

ii. Closed punctuation

Yukur ventures Plc,
P.M.B. 1045,
Makurdi,
Benue state.

2. **Date:** This usually comes immediately below the writers address. It should follow the format day, month and year. For business letters, short forms are not allowed e.g.

9th November 2021

3. **Inside name and address:** this is the designation and address of one correspondent it is usually written on the left hand corner of the page after the date. It should follow the same form with the writers address i.e. if the writers address is in block form, the inside address should also be in block form and vice versa. Similarly, if the writers address has open punctuation, the inside will also have to be in open punctuation and vice versa. E.g.

• The manager,

Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc,
P.O.Box 553,
Maiduguri.

The manager

Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc
P.O.Box 553
Maiduguri

• Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc,
P.O.Box 553,
Maiduguri.

Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc
P.O.Box 553
Maiduguri

4. **Salutation:** This is the normal opening greeting in a business letter. It comes one line space below the inside address e.g.

Dear Sir

Dear Madam

For individual

Dear Sirs

Dear madams

For partnership

Dear Mr. Audu

Dear mrs. Audu

For Long standing customers

5. **Subject, heading or title:** This gives concisely the subject matter on which one is writing e.g. letter of complaint, application for the post of manager etc. thus should be written in bold print.

6. **Body of the letter:** This should be written in paragraphs. The introductory part should clearly specify the purpose of the writing e.g. I wish to apply for the post of manager in your company as advertised in the 'Daily trust' of 9th November 2021. There is need to avoid the use of contracted forms, slangs, colloquialism and Americanisms in business correspondence
7. **Complementary close:** This is the closing greeting in business letter. The complementary close should always be in harmony with the salutation. E.g.

Dear Sir

Dear Madam

Yours Faithfully

Dear Mr. Audu

Dear Mrs. Audu

Yours Sincerely

8. **Writer's name:** This should be written in full. Female should indicate marital status e.g.
Musa Jauro Adamu Maimuna Audu (Mrs.)
9. **Writer's Signature:** This is the signed name or mark of the writer. Signatures are of two types – facsimile signature and signature by proxy.
Facsimile signature is where the writer signs by himself while signature by proxy is where one signs for another person.
10. **Designation of writer:** This may be required in some letters but not in others. Here the writer indicates his rank e.g. manager, Accountant etc.

MEMORANDUM

This is also a form of correspondence which is used within an organization. It is usually written on printed form specifically designed for that purpose. The have the following information printed on them.

- i. The name of the organization e.g. THE FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC MUBI (MEMORANDUM)
- ii. Date
- iii. Reference No
- iv. To
- v. From
- vi. Subject
- vii. Cc

THE FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC MUBI MEMORANDUM

REF No. DGS/FPM/15/2

To: All Heads of Department

From: H.O.D General Studies

Subject: Submission of list of service courses.

I write to request all departments requiring the services of service lecturers from the Department of General Studies to please send the list of each course to reach our Department Examination Officer (D.E.O) not later than 20th August, 2021.

This is to enable us prepare our courses allocation to reach the dateline given by the central time-table committee please.

A.A Banga
Ahmadu A.
Banga
(for H.O.D)

WRITING FOR PUBLICATION

Writing for publication refers to articles, feature stories or well-written essays on a variety of subjects meant for publication in newspapers, magazines, journals, books etc. for a wider audience.

Elements of writing for publication

1. **The writer:** that is the source, originator or initiator of the message. The writer must be certain about what message he has for the public and he should think about the best way to communicate his message, paying attention to his choice of words, styles etc. he also needs to know specifically what he intends to achieve i.e. to inform, to condemn, to correct etc.
2. **The subject matter:** this is the message, information or idea that is conveyed in the form of an essay to the public. What we write for publication are essays on topical and current issues which are of immediate or future benefit to members of the society i.e. political, social, economic, educational, etc
3. **Audience:** the reason for writing is to convey a message to people. Without an audience therefore, there can be no writing let alone publishing it.

Techniques of writing for publication

1. The writer should begin by identifying a topic. Such topic must be the one that the writer is very conversant with.
2. The writer should decide on the scope of the subject matter. He should try and give a focus and direction to his article by narrowing the topic to a specific issue.
3. The writer has to identify and analyze his audience. It is the responsibility of the writer to have specific people in mind for which message is intended.
4. The writer must source for relevant information. In other words, there is the need for him to support his claims with tangible evidence.
5. After publishing the relevant information, the writer organizes them in writing. He said note that an article is a composition which requires an interesting and captivating introduction, a well-developed body in appropriate paragraphs and an impressive conclusion.

REPORT

A report may be defined as a document in which a given problem is examined for the purpose of conveying information, reporting finding. Putting forward ideas and sometimes making recommendations. The report shows how the facts were discovered, the importance of the facts, the conclusions reached and the recommendation made.

Types of a report

- i. **Visit or Field Report:** After visiting a construction site or manufacturing plant you may be asked to write a report for the benefit of others. In your report, you will assess the conditions of the structures and present your findings. Such a report may include diagrams and photographs of the site.
- ii. **Training Report:** as a student on industrial attachment you may be required to write a training report, which will contain your personal experiences with projects, any special responsibilities you took, any problem you encountered and how these problems were solved.

- iii. **Test/Investigation Report:** This report involves test carried out in a laboratory or on a site. The report will include a description of tests carried out, an analysis of the results and any conclusions.
- iv. **Routine Report:** This is presented on a regular basis at specific times of the years, such report are expected to be sent in for example, local education secretaries are expected to send their monthly financial reports to the state primary education boards.
- v. **Special Reports:** this report is not written on routine basis. Rather they arise in response to certain needs. For example an executive who has been away on a course for 12 months may ask his deputy to write a report updating his knowledge.

Uses/purposes of a report: A report serves any of the following purposes:

- i. To present a solution to a problem
- ii. To help the reader make a sound decision by giving him the needed facts.
- iii. To bring people within an organization up to date with happenings inside and outside the institutions.
- iv. Report use for documentation for future reference.
- v. It offers advice in an organization.

Characteristics of good report/qualities of a report

- i. **Clarity:** a good report must be crystal clear, this is because clear writing is a product of clear thinking, facts and interpretation must be carefully organized.
- ii. **Complete and accurate:** a good report must be complete and accurate whether it is short, long within a special it must display this characteristic.
- iii. **Readability:** it is expected a whatever report language that could be use should be to the reader's level.
- iv. **Logical:** points raised in a report must fit it to each other logically.
- v. **Conciseness:** a good report must be concise there should be no room for beating around the bush.

Steps/stages in writing a report: There are our stages in the writing of reports, they are:

- The preparation stage ●The arrangement stage ●The writing stage ●The revision stage
- i. **The Preparation Stage:** is also referred to as the planning stage. The planning stage of a report being with classifying issues related to your purpose your readers and your materials.
- ii. **The Arrangement Stage:** after all the information required for writing the report has been gathered, there would be need to organize them.
- iii. **The Writing Stage:** having decided on the format for the presentation of your report, the net crucial stage in the reporting is the writing stage. The writing stage is that stage when you have to worry about word choice, tone or style, sentences, paragraph development and the overall structure of the report.

Format of a report: The format or layout for a report includes:

- Letter form ●Tabular form or schematic arrangement ●Report in numbered paragraph.

Letter Format

When a report is short, simple and straight forward you use the letter format, such reports are written like formal letter. **Example**

The Head of Department, General Studies Division

Federal Polytechnic Mubi,
9th November 2021

The Chairman,
Curriculum Committee
Federal Polytechnic Mubi

Dear Sir,

Revision of the use of English syllabus for the mature student program.

Terms of reference: On 9th November 2021, your office directed that investigation and recommendation should be made in order to bring the present use of English syllabus in line with realistic needs of mature students.

Findings: The aim of the use of English is not to train English major who would in turn teach English in schools, but to equip students generally in the language they use to express themselves in their officers, business circles and at social gatherings.

Recommendations: Accordingly, the following recommendations are suggested:

1. Parts of speech and their grammatical functions clauses, phrases, description of vowels and consonants sound should be expunged from the syllabus.
2. The use of English for mature students should conclude relevant areas as thus;
The rules of grammatical concord, Correction of poorly spoken and written sentences
Punctuation and capitalization, Direct and indirect speech, Idioms and figurative expression
Public speaking, The use of the library, Introduction to literature
3. The lecture groups should be broken down into smaller groups for effective control and better student participation. The use English teachers should also be sponsored to workshops to improve their language teaching skills.

In the interest of this category of students, please give this request your considerable attention.

Yours faithfully,
(Signature)
Dr. Salim A. Salim

The tabular form or schematic arrangement: When a report runs up to hundreds of pages, it is better to use the tabular format than the letter layout. This tabular format has the following components:

1. Terms of reference
2. Investigation procedure
3. Table of content
4. Heading and sub heading
5. Numbering
6. Findings
7. Conclusions
8. Recommendations
9. Date
10. Signature
11. Designation

Terms of reference: the terms of reference refers to the areas which our report will examine e.g. to find out the total amount of money received by a government owned company from January 2020 to December 2021 and to examine the payment of staff salaries within the stipulated period.

Investigation Procedure: here the writer of the report states how he got the information he used in preparing the report. They include: library for books, civil service rules, financial instruction. The office under investigation for documents, files, account books, audit books, records, cheque leaves, etc. questionnaires, interview, letter, petitions, memoranda and personal observation.

Table of Content: because of the length and complexity of such reports, a table of content is used to breaks down the report into sections.

Heading and Sub Heading: most readers do not have the time to read or are not interested in reading every page of the report.

Numbering: a part from headings, numbering helps the reader know where each section fits into the entire report various method of numbering exist but the most highly recommended is the decimal system. Here major ideas are numbered 1, 2, 3 and 4 in sequential order.

Summary: the summary is a miniature picture of the entire reports. It should conclude a brief background of the matter so that if the reader has not read the report, what he has reads can be intelligible to him.

Findings: this is the body of the report. It consists of all the facts gathered during the investigation.

Conclusions: this is the object assessment of all the facts in the report.

Recommendations: this is the writer's personal view of how the facts discovered should be dealt with.

Signature: the signature is important in a report because it shows that the report writer can be held responsible for what he has written. When the report is written by a committee, it should be sign by all the members.

Report in Numbered Paragraph: this is the third format, which can be used in report writing. This format is used when the reports is not long enough to be grouped under the headings used in the tabular format and when the report is much longer than what should be written in a letter.